

AJINKYA KALE

Lead Product Designer | Customer Experience · UX Strategy · Fintech

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SUMMARY

Lead Product Designer with 9+ years of experience designing customer and enterprise experiences across fintech/BFSI, SaaS and consumer products. Currently leading UX for Kotak Mahindra Bank's Cloud Branch and FYN platforms, simplifying complex banking workflows through user research, interaction design, prototyping, user testing and data-driven design.

SELECTED IMPACT

Kotak Cloud Branch - Simplified large-scale branch operations, cutting authentication clicks and average handling time by 50%.

TrueMeds - Turned customer research and funnel insights into a trust-focused experience that reduced checkout-stage drop-off by 10%.

LoanNearby - Digitized complex lending workflows, reducing approval turnaround from 15 days to same day for Aadhaar-KYC loans.

EXPERIENCE Senior UX Lead — Ungrammary

May 2024 – Present

Design studio staffed onto Kotak Mahindra Bank

Kotak Cloud Branch

- Led product design for a new branch-service platform used by 5,000+ branch staff handling 60M+ annual transactions, consolidating workflows distributed across 10–15 legacy systems.
- Owned end-to-end UX for 6 core banking services, including fund transfer, cash, physical and cheque transactions, translating complex operational, business and technology requirements into scalable workflows.
- Reduced authentication clicks by 50% and average handling time by 50% by consolidating fragmented authentication into a single SSO experience.
- Conducted user research and moderated prototype testing through recorded sessions, task-based questioning and feedback analysis to identify friction and iterate on workflows.
- Designed operational dashboards and data-visualization patterns to help users understand complex information and take faster action.
- Designed Companion, a scoped internal GenAI assistant for branch staff, and Tools, a guided communication experience with predefined templates and tone guardrails.
- Partnered with senior business, product, technology and design stakeholders from problem definition through production rollout while leading a supporting designer.

Kotak FYN — Corporate Banking

- Designed customer experiences across 3 payment rails — IMPS, RTGS and NEFT — and 3 approval roles: Maker, Checker and Authorizer, simplifying high-volume corporate payment journeys.
- Defined complex multi-persona approval workflows balancing customer efficiency, operational controls and compliance requirements.
- Used user research, prototype walkthroughs and moderated testing to identify workflow friction, validate interaction models and refine payment and approval experiences.
- Designed information-heavy dashboards and interaction patterns to make payment status, exceptions and required actions easier to understand.
- Partnered with product and engineering teams throughout active development to translate customer needs and complex banking requirements into scalable experiences.

TrueMeds

- Led a 3-designer team through a strategy-to-execution redesign of a consumer pharmacy experience, combining customer research with product analytics.
- Analyzed the login → dashboard → conversion → checkout funnel to identify customer friction and trust barriers around substitute medicines.
- Reduced checkout-stage drop-off by 20% by designing a doctor-backed education experience addressing customer uncertainty at a critical conversion point.
- Used research insights, prototyping and user testing to validate content, information hierarchy and interaction patterns.

Wellytics

- Led product design for a 0→1 consumer health-tech MVP, partnering directly with the CEO and engineering leadership from concept through execution.
- Translated complex genetic reports, health tracking and habit-building information into accessible customer experiences.
- Designed dashboards and data visualizations to help users interpret complex health information and understand progress over time.
- Designed a GenAI health companion supporting daily routines, conversational follow-up and lightweight nutrition guidance.

Highland Brain — Highland Group

- Led a 2-designer team designing a multi-platform learning ecosystem across mobile, web, tablet and feature phones.
- Unified fragmented student, teacher and school experiences across lectures, submissions, reporting and onboarding.
- Used research, prototyping and iterative validation to refine workflows across multiple personas and devices.

Lead Designer — okoders | D'Accord TechHub LLP

Oct 2021 – Apr 2024

The design team staffed onto Builder.AI

- Progressed from Senior UX/UI Designer to Lead Designer within one year, ultimately building and leading a 7-designer team across multiple product engagements.
- Owned design quality, staffing, hiring, appraisals and project planning while continuing to contribute to product strategy and design delivery.
- Partnered with business and product stakeholders to frame customer problems, define UX requirements and establish delivery teams.
- Managed design delivery across Builder.ai and other client engagements, balancing customer needs, project requirements and delivery quality.

21K School

- Worked as an individual contributor within a 10+ designer global team, owning the multi-school administration experience and expanding the information architecture to support a significantly broader feature set.

IMSOM — Indian Music Society of Minnesota

- Led an end-to-end customer experience redesign spanning ticketing, concert entry and event follow-ups, contributing to a 20% increase in membership after launch.

Eservz

- Led a customer-facing website redesign that contributed to a 10% increase in inbound leads and 10% client-base growth following launch.

UI Designer → Product Designer — Nearby Technologies Pvt Ltd

Mar 2017 – Sep 2021

- Joined as an intern and became the company's first designer, growing with the organization from approximately 100 to 500+ employees.
- Designed 16 digital products and 20+ service modules across PayNearby, BuyNearby and LoanNearby, spanning payments, lending, insurance and merchant experiences.
- Designed services including Aadhaar ATM, UPI, Bharat QR, money transfer, insurance and credit-score experiences across consumer and merchant journeys.

LoanNearby

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- Owned end-to-end product design for a multi-persona lending platform spanning CRM lead creation, CIBIL credit checks and multi-level approvals.
 - Designed the lending experience for PayNearby and Yes Bank, simplifying workflows across customers, operations and approval stakeholders.
 - Reduced consumer-loan approval time from 15 days to same day for Aadhaar-KYC loans and to 6 days for larger loans by digitizing workflows and streamlining multi-signatory approvals.
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**CORE
EXPERTISE**

Customer Experience Design · Product Design · UX Strategy · User Research · User Testing · Interaction Design · Information Architecture · Data-Driven Design · Dashboard & Data Visualization · Prototyping · Enterprise & B2B UX · 0→1 Product Design · GenAI & Conversational UX · Design Systems · Design Leadership · Stakeholder Management

EDUCATION

MCA — Mumbai Education Trust, Mumbai University | 2013–2016
BCA — Shivaji Science College, RTMNU, Nagpur | 2010–2013

**CERTIFICATI
ONS**

Design Thinking & Innovation — IIT Delhi | 2022
Human-Centered Design — Acumen Academy & IDEO.org | 2020
Human-Computer Interaction — Interaction Design Foundation | 2019

TOOLS

Figma · FigJam · Jira · Miro · Zeplin · Adobe XD · Sketch